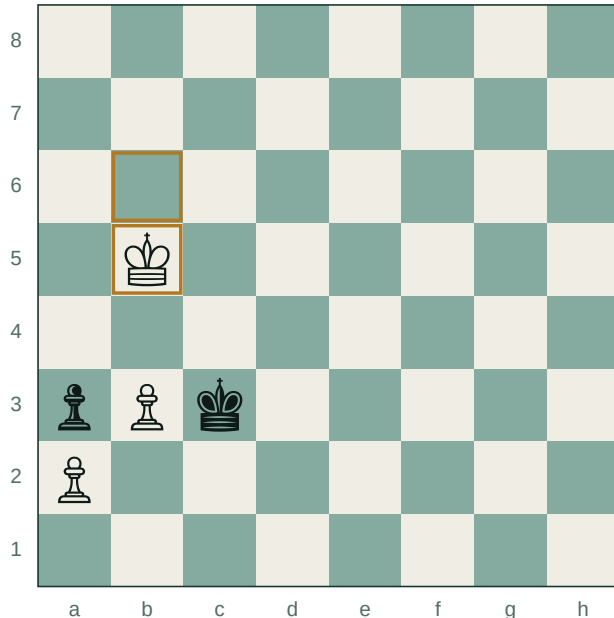


# Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 53

Advanced-pawn tactics

## Black to move



Previous move: 53.Kb5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

**53...Kb2 54. Kc4 Kxa2 55. Kc3 Kb1 56. b4 a2**

**53...Kb2** The king moves from c3 to b2. Recorded reply: **54.Kc4**.

**54...Kxa2** The king captures the pawn on a2. Recorded reply: **55.Kc3**.

**55...Kb1** The king moves from a2 to b1. Recorded reply: **56.b4**.

**56...a2** The pawn moves from a3 to a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

## HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on b5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.